

Payment one — cash, now · capital expenditure, FY2026 guide USD 130–145bn

Payment two — earnings, later · depreciation the 5.5-year clock defers out of 2026–28E ~USD 38bn

THE DOSE · CAPEX PER DOLLAR OF NET INCOME, Q2 2026

USD 1.96

TECH-EQUITY VALUATION · COMMUNICATION SERVICES / INTERACTIVE MEDIA · THE DEPRECIATION RECKONING — “PAYING TWICE”

Paying Twice

Meta buys its machines with cash today and pays for them again in earnings tomorrow. In the June quarter the first payment reached \$31.1bn against \$15.8bn of net income — and the second payment, on the longest server clock in Big Tech, has barely begun. We value the stock with both invoices on the table.

TON618 CAPITAL RESEARCH · AS OF JULY 31, 2026 · REPORT DATE 2026-07-31 · DATA AS-OF 2026-07-30 CLOSE

Every filed figure is drawn from Meta's own SEC filings and investor-relations documents and is as-of dated; model figures are labelled as estimates and separated from filed fact throughout. Prices are as of the July 30, 2026 close. This note is a satellite of The Depreciation Reckoning series and applies its published July model to Meta; §7 documents sources, formulas and the model's disclosed limitations, including the fitted parameter inside the Meta re-mark.

Meta Platforms, Inc.

NASDAQ: META

\$1.96

SPENT ON INFRASTRUCTURE PER
DOLLAR OF NET INCOME, Q2
2026 — TWELVE MONTHS
EARLIER THE RATIO WAS \$1.15

The view. We value Meta at **\$370 per share** against the July 30 close of **\$539.03** — a **31% gap** to fair value, on a 12–18 month evaluation window. The operating engine is genuinely strong: revenue grew 28% in Q2 on both more ads (+14%) and dearer ads (+12%). But net income *fell 14%*, the capital-expenditure guide's floor *rose again* — \$115bn in January, \$125bn in April, \$130bn now — free cash flow was \$784M — 2.5 cents kept per dollar of operating cash — and depreciation, growing at 46%, is only the front edge of a wave Meta's 5.5-year server schedule defers into 2027–28. Even our bull case, blended across methods, sits at \$532 — below today's price. The market is no longer ignoring this: the stock fell 8% on the print. We think it has another instalment to go.

\$130–145bn

FY2026 capex guide — the floor has risen \$15bn since January while income fell

–14%

Q2 net income, \$15.8bn vs \$18.3bn — the first down quarter of the AI build

\$784M

Q2 free cash flow, down from \$8.5bn — 2.5% of the quarter's capex

+46%

Q2 depreciation & amortisation growth — 1.6× the pace of revenue

Executive summary

Fair value \$370 per share against the \$539.03 close of 30 July 2026 — a 31% gap. Bull blend \$532, base \$370; 12–18 month evaluation window.

- **The revenue machine is genuinely strong.** Q2 revenue +28% to \$60.8bn, on 14% more ad impressions *and* 12% higher pricing at once.
- **The cost of producing it is now the story.** Net income *fell 14%*; free cash flow was \$784M against \$31.1bn of capex; buybacks went to zero and \$24.9bn of new debt was issued.
- **The dose has nearly doubled in a year.** Capex per dollar of net income went 1.15× (FY2025) to **1.96×** in the June quarter — and the capex guide's floor rose again, \$115bn in January to \$130bn now.
- **The second payment has barely begun.** Meta runs the longest server clock in Big Tech at 5.5 years; the house three-year clock re-marks FY2025 EPS \$23.49 to **\$21.56** and defers roughly \$38bn across 2026–28.

Where to find the work: the re-mark is §3, the valuation §4, the case against us §5, and the series context §6.

The story so far

On 17 July we published The Depreciation Question — Big Tech expensing a record hardware build on schedules that flatter earnings, roughly \$221bn deferred out of 2026–28. On 30 July, The First Invoice scored it against the Q2 prints: four-for-four on accelerating depreciation, every clock held. This note applies that framework to the

name it bears hardest on. **Meta's chapter role: the extender at the limit** — the longest clock in the group, the steepest shift of capex into server-class assets, and now a dose approaching 2×. Meta reported Q2 on 29 July; the stock fell 8%, its second consecutive ~8% earnings-day decline.

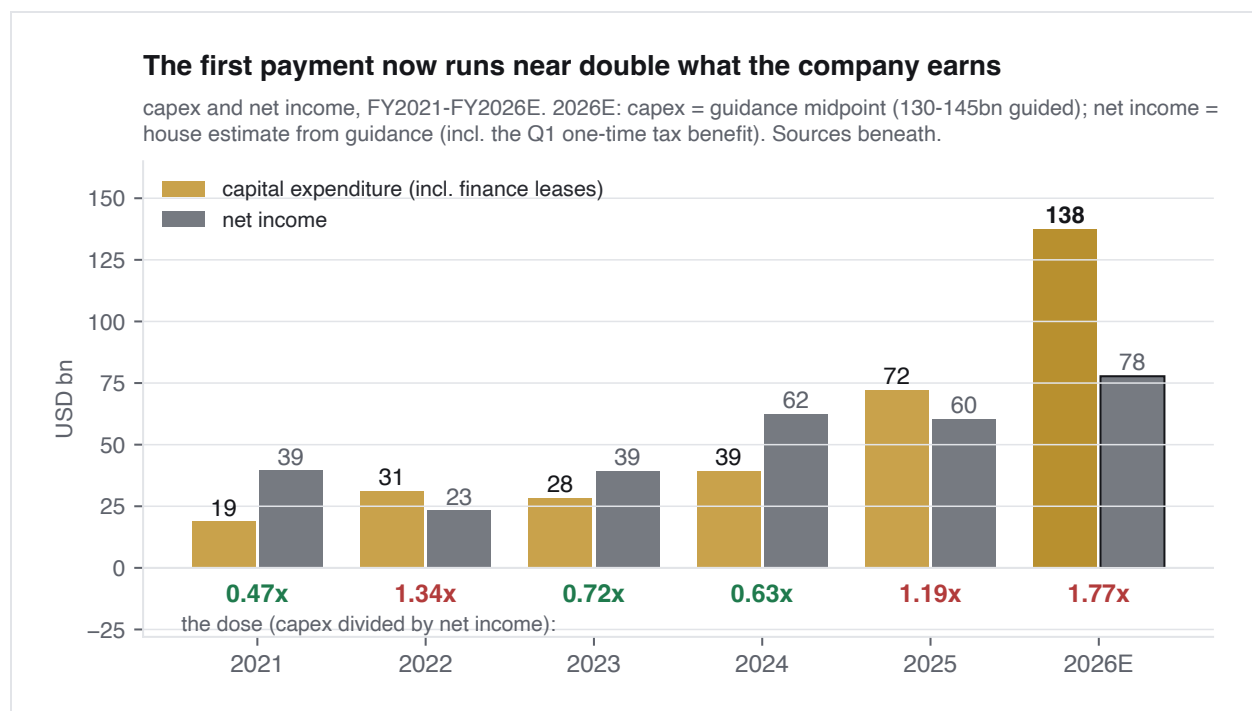
§1 Two payments for the same machines

Every server Meta buys is paid for twice. The first payment is cash, immediately: capital expenditure, running at \$31.1bn in the June quarter alone. The second payment is earnings, later: depreciation, the accounting charge that spreads each machine's cost across the years of its assumed useful life. The cash payment is visible the day it happens. The earnings payment arrives on a schedule management chooses — and Meta has chosen the longest server schedule in Big Tech: **5.5 years**, extended in January 2025, at a moment when the hardware it is buying turns over on a roughly two-year architecture cycle.

The choice is legal, disclosed, and audited, and this note alleges nothing improper. What the choice does is *move* the second payment. Meta's own FY2025 10-K quantifies the move: the extension cut 2025 depreciation by **\$2.92bn** and added **\$2.59bn to net income** — **\$1.00 of the year's \$23.49 of diluted EPS** — from the stroke of an estimate. Our July research (The Depreciation Question) put the cumulative version of that arithmetic at roughly **\$38bn of depreciation deferred out of Meta's 2026–28 earnings** on the house clock (a model estimate; §3). The deferral does not cancel the bill. It schedules it.

What makes Meta the extreme case in our series is the dose — capital expenditure divided by net income, the one ratio this series carries everywhere. When the dose is low, as at Apple (0.07×), the schedule is a rounding error. When it approaches 2×, the schedule *is* the income statement. Meta's dose was 1.15× across FY2025. In the June quarter it reached **1.96×** — and on our full-year estimates it holds near **1.8×** for 2026. Among the hyperscalers only Amazon (~2.3× trailing, ex-gains) runs hotter, and both are walking toward Oracle — at 3.26×, the company whose fiscal-2026 earnings our July note found 26% overstated (17% in fiscal 2025).

EXHIBIT 1 — THE FIRST PAYMENT, DRAWN AGAINST WHAT THE COMPANY EARNS



Source: Meta Forms 10-K FY2023–FY2025 (capex = purchases of property and equipment + principal payments on finance leases, per cash-flow statements); FY2021–22 capex from the July model's cash-basis series; FY2026E = guidance midpoint per the Q2-26 8-K Ex-99.1 (0001628280-26-050596) and TON618 net-income estimate from that guidance. Net income per 10-Ks. Data as of 2026-07-31.

§2 What the quarter actually said

Data shows a very strong revenue machine. Q2 revenue was **\$60.80bn, up 28%** (27% constant-currency) — faster than Alphabet, faster than Microsoft — on 3.60bn daily active people (+3%), **14% more ad impressions and a 12% higher average price per ad**. Growth is coming from volume *and* price at once, which is what a working AI-recommendation flywheel looks like. Family of Apps produced \$23.4bn of operating income; Reality Labs lost another \$4.6bn.

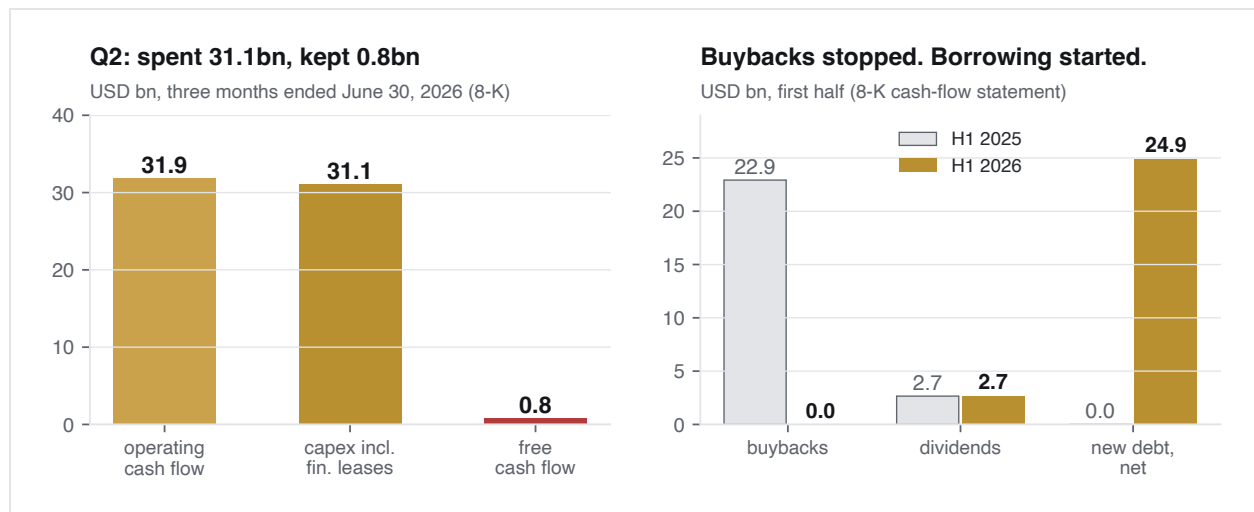
Data also shows the cost of producing it. Total costs and expenses rose **55%**, to \$42.0bn. Operating income *fell* 8% to \$18.8bn — a **31% operating margin against 43%** a year earlier. Net income fell 14% to \$15.8bn; diluted EPS fell 13% to \$6.18. Two charges the company disclosed depress the quarter: **\$2.40bn of legal-proceedings charges and \$1.18bn of severance** from the May headcount reduction (~8,000 roles). We normalise transparently: add back the \$3.58bn pre-tax at the quarter's 16% tax rate and normalised net income is roughly **\$18.9bn — up about 3%** on a year ago; management's own framing is that operating income ex-charges rose 9%. Either way, a company growing revenue 28% grew underlying profit at mid-single digits, because infrastructure costs, depreciation, AI compensation and third-party compute are growing faster than the top line. Share-based compensation alone rose **52%** in the half, to \$13.7bn — 11.7% of revenue.

And the guidance moved the wrong way for the bulls' story. Three revisions, all in the same direction:

GUIDE (FY2026)	BEFORE	AFTER Q2	READING
Capital expenditure (incl. finance leases)	\$115–135bn (Jan) → \$125–145bn (Apr)	\$130– 145bn	The <i>floor</i> has risen \$15bn in six months. Midpoint \$137.5bn ≈ +90% on FY2025's \$72.2bn
Total expenses	\$162–169bn (Apr, "unchanged from our prior outlook")	\$165– 169bn	Lower end raised \$3bn to absorb the \$2.4bn legal charge
Tax rate (remaining quarters)	13–16%	15–17%	Raised
2027 capex	—	No outlook offered	"Infrastructure planning remains highly dynamic" — plans are "geared towards maximizing 2026 and '27 capacity" (call)

The funding of the build has quietly changed the shareholder's deal. Free cash flow for the quarter was **\$784M** — against \$8.5bn a year ago — because \$31.1bn of the \$31.9bn of operating cash went straight back out the door as capex. Buybacks, \$22.9bn in the first half of 2025, were **zero** in the first half of 2026; the dividend (\$1.35bn a quarter) continues. In their place: **\$24.9bn of new long-term debt** issued in the quarter, taking the debt balance from \$58.7bn at year-end to **\$83.7bn**, plus what the CFO described as a broadened "aperture" including financing partnerships. Property and equipment on the balance sheet grew **\$49.3bn in six months** — more than Meta's entire 2023 capex year — to \$225.7bn. None of this is concealed; all of it is a different company from the buyback machine of 2023–24.

EXHIBIT 2 — WHERE THE CASH WENT, AND WHERE IT CAME FROM



Source: Meta Q2-2026 Form 8-K Ex-99.1 (0001628280-26-050596, filed 2026-07-29), condensed consolidated statements of cash flows and non-GAAP reconciliation. Data as of 2026-07-31.

The market's verdict on the quarter was not gentle: **-8.0% the next session** (to \$539.03, on 3.5× average volume), the second consecutive earnings day the stock has dropped roughly 8%, leaving it 32% below its 52-week high. Press accounts of the sell-off centred on the capex floor and the absence of any 2027 spending frame — press-sourced, and consistent with what the filing shows.

§3 The clock at the limit: the second payment, re-marked

Everything in this section that is not from a filing is a model estimate, and is labelled as such.

Meta discloses more about its depreciation choices than most of its peers, and the disclosures tell a clean story. Servers and network assets carry a **"five to 5.5 years"** life, the top end set by the January 2025 extension from the prior disclosed "four to five years" — worth a disclosed **\$2.92bn of depreciation relief in 2025**, and pre-announced in the FY2024 10-K at "approximately \$2.9 billion" before the year began. Server-class purchases have gone from **27% of capex in 2021 to 58% in 2024** (43% in 2025 as data-centre construction surged alongside): the fastest disclosed shift toward short-lived assets in the group, expensed on the group's longest clock. At year-end, another **\$50.5bn sat in construction-in-progress** — bought, on the balance sheet, not yet depreciating at all.

The July model re-marks Meta's earnings onto a three-year server clock — our estimate of the economic life of AI-cycle compute, argued in the July note from NVIDIA's two-year architecture cadence and the resale-value evidence. On that clock:

FY2025, RE-MARKED ON THE HOUSE CLOCK (MODEL ESTIMATE)

\$23.49

Diluted EPS as reported, FY2025 Form 10-K



\$21.56

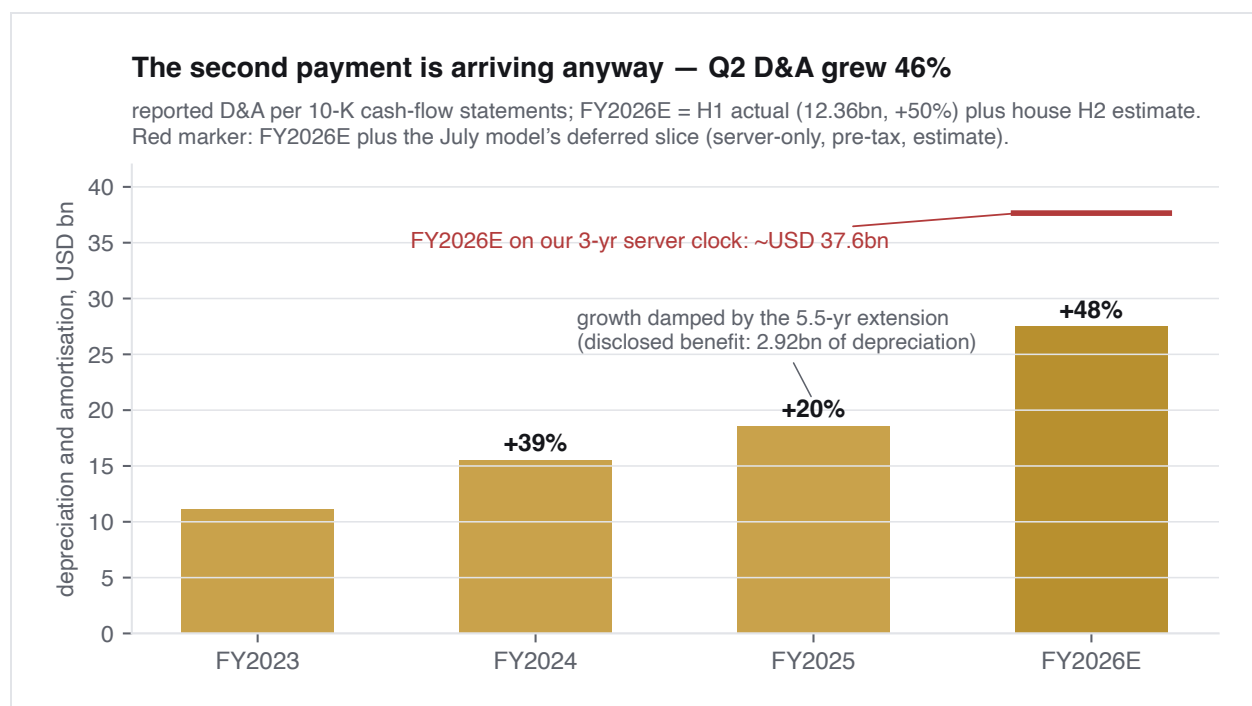
Diluted EPS on a 3-year server clock — net income
9.0% lower

July v3 vintage model (published 17 Jul 2026, unchanged): server share of capex 43%, straight-line, pre-tax delta \$7.06bn taxed at the year's effective rate. A model estimate, not a restatement; Meta's reported figures comply with GAAP.

Forward, the deferral compounds. On the model's assumptions (43% server share, capex held at \$130bn — the *floor* of the current guide, so the estimate is conservative), the 5.5-year schedule defers roughly **\$10.2bn of depreciation out of 2026, \$13.6bn out of 2027 and \$14.8bn out of 2028** — about \$38bn across the window, pre-tax. Marked against our FY2026 estimates, reported EPS of ~\$30.3 would read ~\$27.0 on the house clock (~\$24.7 if one also normalises the one-time Q1 tax benefit and Q2 charges).

The wave has started arriving on Meta's own numbers. The model's core forward claim — depreciation must accelerate sharply as the 2024–25 vintages land, schedule or no schedule — was published on 17 July. Twelve days later Meta reported Q2 D&A of \$6.36bn, **up 46%**, with the half up 50% — against 28% revenue growth. That is the acceleration, on schedule. It is worth remembering what FY2025's gentler 20% D&A growth actually was: growth *after* a \$2.92bn subsidy from the extension.

EXHIBIT 3 — THE SECOND PAYMENT, ARRIVING



Source: Meta FY2025 Form 10-K (D&A per consolidated cash-flow statements, FY2023–25) and Q2-2026 8-K Ex-99.1 (H1 D&A); FY2026E is H1 actual plus TON618 H2 estimate. Red marker: FY2026E plus the July model's 2026 deferred slice of \$10.2bn (server-only, pre-tax) — a model estimate. Data as of 2026-07-31.

An honesty note the reader should carry. The Meta leg of the July model contains a **fitted parameter**: Meta's pre-2025 blended server life is set at **4.65 years**, chosen *inside* Meta's own disclosed "four to five years" range so that modelled depreciation tracks reported server depreciation. The model's agreement with Meta's disclosed 2025 extension benefit is therefore **not an independent validation** — the validation work in the July note rests on the other companies' disclosed life-change benefits. And the deeper uncertainty runs in Meta's favour if resolved one way: if AI-era servers really do earn for 5.5 years — management cited demand for its compute "at a significant premium" to cost on the Q2 call — then the schedule is honest and our re-mark is too harsh. We hold the three-year view for the reasons argued in July, and we flag the assumption because the reader deserves to know which numbers are load-bearing.

The confirmation, on file. The Q2 Form 10-Q (accession 0001628280-26-050705, filed July 30) discloses **no change in estimate: the 5.5-year server schedule held**. It also files a figure sharper than the release's blended D&A line — **servers-and-network depreciation of \$4.62bn for the quarter and \$9.01bn for the half** — the directly-disclosed form of the acceleration this section models. Both facts cut the same way: the clock is unchanged, and the bill on it is compounding.

\$4 What the stock is worth when both payments count

Method selection. Meta is a leveraged, dividend-paying, high-growth equity in the middle of a capital-structure shift (buybacks suspended, debt rising). We therefore value the equity directly with a **multi-stage FCFE model** (60% weight), cross-checked by **relative multiples** on forward earnings run on both the reported and the re-marked basis (40% weight). A sum-of-the-parts adds nothing here — Reality Labs is a cost centre, not a valuation segment — and we say so rather than manufacture a third method.

House conventions, stated up front. Stock-based compensation is treated as the real expense it is: it stays inside our EBITDA and is never added back to cash flow; in exchange, the diluted share count (2,566M) is held flat rather than inflated forward — grant cost is charged at grant value once. Cost of equity is built from CAPM with nothing softened: 4.67% ten-year Treasury (July 29, FRED), beta 1.35 (computed, two years of daily closes against SPY), 4.5% equity risk premium — **10.75%**. Tax 17% (top of guide). Terminal growth 3.5%. Every scenario funds the capex trough with modelled debt issuance and pays the after-tax interest on it.

The 2026 base year is built from Meta's own guidance, not hope: H1 actuals, Q3 at the guide midpoint (\$62.5bn, +22%), Q4 fading to +19%, gives **\$250.9bn of revenue (+25%)**; the \$165–169bn expense guide gives **\$83.9bn of operating income** — Meta's own "above 2025" language, just barely. Net income ~\$77.8bn (**EPS ~\$30.3**, flattered by the Q1 one-time tax benefit; ~\$28.0 normalised). Capex at the guide midpoint: **\$137.5bn**. Free cash flow before new borrowing: approximately **zero**.

SCENARIO (PROB.)	WHAT IT ASSUMES	REVENUE 2032E	FCFE VALUE/SH
Bear (25%)	AI monetisation stalls; ads decelerate to +10%→+4%; EBITDA margin stuck at 44%; capex never below 28% of revenue (terminal 26%)	\$364bn	\$137
Base (50%)	Growth fades +16.5%→+7% (10.8% CAGR); margin recovers to 47%; capex glides 55%→25% of revenue (terminal 22%)	\$464bn	\$289
Bull (25%)	AI ads + agents + compute sales; +19%→+9% growth; 49% margin; capex to 19% (terminal 16%)	\$520bn	\$480

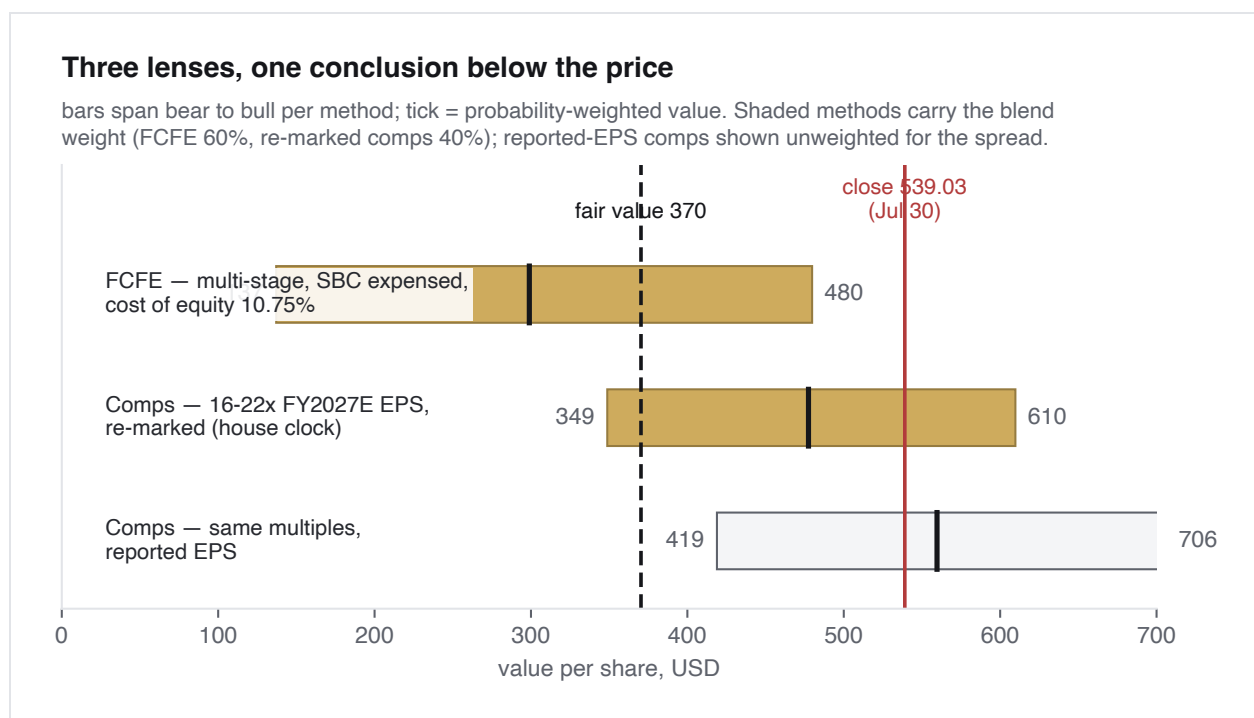
Probability-weighted FCFE value: **\$299**. The interim years are the story: even in the base case, cumulative 2026–29 free cash flow to equity is barely positive *including* \$125bn of modelled new debt — the equity holder is paying the first invoice for years before the model lets them collect.

The comps lens — and the \$82 the clock is worth. On FY2027E earnings the three scenarios give EPS of \$26.2 / \$30.1 / \$32.1. At 16× / 18.5× / 22× — a discount to Microsoft's 25× and the market's ~23×, for a company whose margin is falling and whose earnings carry a 2× dose — the reported-EPS comps value is **\$560**: on reported earnings and a market-average multiple, Meta is roughly fairly priced today. Apply the same multiples to *re-marked* FY2027E EPS (less the model's \$4.38/share 2027 deferral, after tax) and the value is **\$477**. The spread between those two numbers — **\$82 per share** on unrounded figures — is what the 5.5-year clock is worth in the multiple lens, and it is the cleanest single expression of this note's thesis: the P/E is only reasonable if you believe the E.

METHOD	WEIGHT	BEAR	BASE	BULL	PROB-WEIGHTED
FCFE — multi-stage, SBC expensed, Ke 10.75%	60%	\$137	\$289	\$480	\$299
Comps — 16–22× FY2027E EPS, re-marked	40%	\$349	\$476	\$610	\$477
<i>Comps — same multiples, reported EPS (shown for the spread; unweighted)</i>	—	\$419	\$557	\$706	\$560
Blended fair value	100%	\$222	\$364	\$532	\$370

Run the whole blend on reported-basis comps instead and fair value is \$403 — the re-mark moves the house number by \$33; the FCFE leg, being cash-based, does not move at all (a depreciation schedule changes no cash flow; it changes what reported earnings mean while the cash goes out regardless).

EXHIBIT 4 — THE FOOTBALL FIELD



Source: TON618 analysis; model.py in the build folder reproduces every figure from the Phase-0 snapshot. Data as of 2026-07-31.

The payoff shape, from \$539.03:

SCENARIO	PROB.	BLENDED VALUE	RETURN
Bear	25%	\$222	–58.8%
Base	50%	\$364	–32.5%
Bull	25%	\$532	–1.3%
Expected	100%	\$370	–31.3%

We believe the shape matters as much as the centre: **the case where we are wrong still pays approximately nothing**. Six years of 13%+ compound growth, record margins, capex falling to 16% of revenue and a 22× multiple on re-marked earnings — and the stock roughly round-trips to today's price. The bear case is a -59% de-rating.

The reverse question. Work backwards from \$539.03 through the base engine, one variable at a time, and the price requires: a **22.8% six-year revenue CAGR** sustained to 2032 (base: 10.8% — a pace Meta has touched in single years but has not sustained over six since its revenue base was a fraction of today's \$251bn), *or* terminal capex of **3.4% of revenue** (below even pre-AI Meta's ~15%), *or* a **7.8% cost of equity** (a 2.3% equity risk premium), *or* **7.0% perpetual growth**. None is individually defensible — which tells us the market price is not resting on any one heroic input but on a blend of Street conventions (SBC added back, softer discount rates) plus genuine optimism on AI monetisation. Unlike our Alphabet note, where three convention changes reproduced the market price almost exactly, Meta's price needs the optimism too.

Sensitivity, honestly displayed. Terminal capex intensity is worth \$161/share across 16%→28% on the FCFE leg (\$370→\$209 at the blend level of that leg); each 100bp of cost of equity is worth ~\$50; terminal growth 2.5%→4.0% spans ~\$52. The single most valuable disclosure Meta could make for this model is a 2027 capex number — precisely the disclosure management declined to give.

§5 The case against this ledger

Likelihood and magnitude scored 1–5 over 12 months; score is the product.

RISK TO OUR FAIR-VALUE VIEW / TO THE STOCK	L	M	SCORE	QUANTIFICATION
Terminal capital intensity never normalises — the "temporary" build becomes permanent	4	5	20	\$161/sh across the modelled range on the FCFE leg; management gave no 2027 frame
Depreciation wave compresses margins faster than modelled	5	3	15	Direction near-certain (Q2 D&A +46%); FY26–28 deferral \$38bn (model estimate)
AI-compensation and compute cost war persists	4	3	12	SBC +52% H1 to 11.7% of revenue; costs +55% vs revenue +28%
Ad growth decelerates into the spend (bear path)	2	5	10	Bear FCFE \$137; ads are 97.6% of revenue — one engine pays for everything
Legal / regulatory: youth trials, EU	4	2	8	\$2.4bn charged in Q2 alone; company flags possible "material loss" on US youth trials
Upside risk to a short view: AI monetises visibly (agents, compute resale at premium, ad share gains)	3	4	12	Bull blend \$532; compute "offers at a significant premium" per the call

Market risk: 30-day realised volatility is 53.6% annualised (beta 1.35); a one-day 5% move is routine around prints — position sizing must assume it. **Governance:** the dual-class structure gives Class B (13.5% of shares, ten votes each) roughly 61% of the vote; the founder controls the spend, and the capex programme is not practically subject to shareholder discipline. That cuts both ways and we score it inside the capital-intensity risk.

The steelmanned bull case, at full strength. First, *the engine is accelerating, not decaying*: +28% revenue at this scale, on volume and price simultaneously, is the strongest ad print in Big Tech; ex-charges operating income still grew 9%, and the ~8,000-role May restructuring takes its compensation cost out of the run-rate from Q4. Second, *the capex may be underwritten*: management says outside parties are offering to pay "a significant premium" over Meta's cost for its compute — if true at scale, the marginal data centre is NPV-positive even before Meta's own use, and our terminal-capex fear is misplaced. Third, *the clock may be right*: if utilisation, not obsolescence, governs economic life — and capacity is this scarce — 5.5 years is defensible and the re-mark overstates the distortion; we disclosed exactly this uncertainty in §3. Fourth, the multiple already de-rated: 17.8× our FY2026E reported EPS is cheaper than Microsoft (25×), Alphabet on clean earnings (32×), and the S&P (~23×). If 2027 capex is guided flat and margins inflect, the bull blend of \$532 becomes the base — we concede the thesis in that world and say so now.

What would change our mind, with dates.

CATALYST	WHEN	WHAT WE WATCH
Q3-2026 Form 10-Q	~late Oct 2026	The next useful-life note and the servers-depreciation split — the running check on §3 (the Q2 10-Q, filed 30 Jul, held 5.5 years)
Q3-2026 print	Late Oct 2026	Margin ex-charges; any first frame on 2027 capex; D&A run-rate vs our ~\$27.5bn FY26E
FY2026 results + FY2027 capex guide	Late Jan 2027	The single biggest input to fair value. A guide implying capex/revenue on a stated glide path below ~40% moves us to HOLD
US youth-safety trials	Through 2026	Company's own "material loss" language; a second \$2bn+ charge year would mark the legal line as structural

Levels, against the \$370 fair value: above \$585 (the pre-print close) the gap to fair value is at its widest; at the \$539 close the valuation argument is fully against the price; near \$390 the valuation argument is exhausted — neutral; at **\$278** (a 25% margin of safety to fair value) long interest begins if the operating KPIs are intact. We would concede outright on a 2027 capex guide at or below ~\$140bn *with* a stated glide path, or two consecutive quarters of 45%+ ex-charge operating margin while ad growth holds above 20%: in that world the bull engine is the right one and the stock is roughly fairly priced. The Fund holds no position in META, and this note does not recommend initiating a short; a conviction this dependent on the timing of a capex cycle has no reliable clock, and at 53.6% realised volatility, carry is expensive in both directions.

§6 Where this note sits in the series

This is the Meta satellite of The Depreciation Question (July 17) and its Q2 scoreboard The First Invoice (July 30). In that framework Meta is **the extender at the limit**: the longest server clock of the four hyperscalers (5.5 years), the steepest disclosed shift of capex into server-class assets (27% → 58% → 43%), and — as of this quarter — a dose near 2×, compounding fastest toward the Oracle end of the curve, where the July note found fiscal-2026 earnings 26% overstated. The scoreboard's Q2 verdict (depreciation accelerating four-for-four, doses rising everywhere, every clock held — confirmed by all three late-filed 10-Qs, Meta's included) is the out-of-sample evidence this valuation stands on. The siblings each carry one face of the same invoice: Microsoft held its clock

while the bill arrived fastest; Alphabet is the benchmark the group is measured against; Amazon is the only company that shortened a clock, and pays for the honesty in cash; Apple is the control the framework is tested against. The series re-scores itself every earnings season.

§7 Sources & Method

Every filed figure is drawn from Meta's SEC filings via EDGAR or Meta's investor-relations site, pulled and verified on **July 31, 2026**; market data from verified end-of-day sources on the same date. Model figures come from the July v3 vintage model, published 17 July 2026 and unchanged since. The full Phase-0 capture, with per-feed timestamps, content hashes and failure log, is archived in the snapshot manifest ([ton618-tech-valuation/data/META/2026-07-31-052859](#)).

Filings and issuer documents relied upon. Q2-2026 Form 8-K Exhibit 99.1, filed 29 Jul 2026 (0001628280-26-050596) — Q2/H1 income statement, balance sheet, cash flows, segments, operational metrics, all FY2026 guidance figures and guidance language. FY2025 Form 10-K, filed 29 Jan 2026 (0001628280-26-003942) — FY2023–25 statements; the useful-life policy table ("servers and network assets: five to 5.5 years"); the change-in-estimate disclosure (January 2025 assessment, effective 1 Jan 2025; FY2025 impact \$2.92bn depreciation / \$2.59bn net income / \$1.00 per diluted share, quoted verbatim in §3); PP&E components including \$50.5bn construction-in-progress; capital-return detail; cover-page share counts (2,187.2M Class A, 342.4M Class B at 23 Jan 2026). FY2024 Form 10-K, filed 30 Jan 2025 (0001326801-25-000017) — the prior "four to five years" policy table and the pre-announcement of the 5.5-year change ("approximately \$2.9 billion"). Q1-2026 Form 8-K Exhibit 99.1, filed 29 Apr 2026 (0001628280-26-028364) — the prior FY2026 guidance ranges (capex \$125–145bn "increased from our prior range of \$115–135bn"; expenses \$162–169bn) and Q1 capex. Q3-2025 Form 10-Q, filed 30 Oct 2025 (0001628280-25-047240) — Q3-25 revenue (\$51,242M) for the quarterly build; Q4-25 derived as FY minus nine months. Q2-2026 Form 10-Q, filed 30 Jul 2026 (0001628280-26-050705) — the useful-life confirmation (no change in estimate; 5.5 years holds) and the servers-and-network depreciation split (\$4.62bn Q2 / \$9.01bn H1). Meta's own posted Q2-2026 earnings-call transcript ([investor.atmeta.com](#)) — the 2027-capex, ex-charges-operating-income, compute-premium and capital-structure quotations; this is an issuer document, not a third-party transcript.

Market data and rates. Prices are adjusted daily closes from Massive Market Data: anchor close \$539.03 (30 Jul 2026, first session after the print, -7.95%); pre-print close \$585.61 (29 Jul); 52-week intraday range \$520.26–\$796.25 (251 sessions to 30 Jul); year-to-date -18.3% from the \$660.09 year-end close. Market capitalisation ~\$1.37tn on ~2,545M shares outstanding (cover-page count plus H1 issuance; the 10-Q updates this). Beta 1.35 computed from two years of daily closes against SPY; 30-day realised volatility 53.6% annualised, same series. Risk-free rate 4.67%, ten-year constant-maturity Treasury (FRED DGS10, 29 Jul 2026). Peer closes (30 Jul): MSFT \$451.10, GOOGL \$333.66, AMZN \$235.50, AAPL \$333.43. Consensus expectations for the quarter (~\$7.2 EPS, ~\$60.2bn revenue) and sell-off attribution are press-sourced (CNBC, Yahoo Finance, 24/7 Wall St; 29–30 Jul) and are used only as context, never as inputs.

Formulas and conventions. Dose = capex (including finance-lease principal, as Meta guides) ÷ net income, same window; the FY2025 dose (1.15×) uses cash purchases only, matching the July note's basis, and the difference is ~4%. Q2 normalised net income = reported + \$3.58bn charges × (1 – 0.16); a portion of the legal charge may be non-deductible, which would raise the normalised figure slightly. FY2026E revenue = H1 actual + Q3 guide midpoint + Q4 at +19%; operating income = revenue – expense-guide midpoint; the resulting EPS (~\$30.3) includes the Q1 one-time tax benefit (~\$3.31/share, derived from the H1 tax line) and is shown normalised (~\$28.0) alongside. FCFE = EBIT×(1–17%) + D&A – capex – after-tax net interest + net borrowing, discounted at Ke 10.75% (CAPM: 4.67% + 1.35 × 4.5%), mid-year convention from a 31 Jul 2026 valuation date, terminal Gordon growth 3.5% (bear 3.0%). SBC is never added back and the 2,566M diluted count is held flat. The re-mark deltas

(\$10.2/\$13.6/\$14.8bn pre-tax, 2026–28) are the July v3 model's Meta rows: 43% server share, straight-line, model capex \$130bn — the floor of the current guide, making the deltas conservative. Re-marked EPS deducts the year's delta $\times (1 - 17\%) \div 2,566\text{M}$.

Limitations, stated. (1) The Meta re-mark's pre-2025 blended life (4.65 years) is a **fitted parameter** within Meta's disclosed range; the Meta leg is not independently validated (§3) — the model's independent validation rests on other companies' disclosed life-change benefits. (2) The Q2-2026 10-Q (0001628280-26-050705, filed July 30) was incorporated before release: no change in estimate is disclosed, closing the 5.5-year confirmation; its servers-and-network depreciation split (\$4.62bn Q2 / \$9.01bn H1) is cited in §3. (3) The 4.5% equity risk premium is an analyst assumption with high leverage on the output; the sensitivity table prices the disagreement. (4) FY2026E net income depends on the expense-guide midpoint; the guide is \$165–169bn wide, worth roughly $\pm \$1.6\text{bn}$ of net income. (5) Q4-2025 revenue is derived (FY minus nine months), not separately filed. Each chart carries its source beneath it.

§8 Disclosures

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